Midnight to Dawn — Demon Slayer Portfolio Screenplay

Nov 8, 2026 · @Akhilesh

Director's vision

The whole portfolio is one night, told as a single unbroken camera journey from midnight in the castle to sunrise in the mansion. The visitor never sees a page load; every page is a place the camera travels to.

Logline: A lone swordsman falls into an endless castle, finds a moment of calm, fights beside the Pillars, defeats the strongest demons and their King, and wakes at dawn to leave a message for whoever came along for the ride.

The arc in one line per act:

1. **Act 0 — Breath** (Loading): the visitor breathes in with the swordsman.
2. **Act 1 — The Fall** (Home): chaos, speed, the name revealed on a door.
3. **Act 2 — The Quiet Room** (About): silence and warmth after the chaos.
4. **Act 3 — The Battlefield** (Skills): the Pillars fight, each defeat leaves a skill behind.
5. **Act 4 — The Upper Ranks** (Projects): each strong demon is a problem you solved.
6. **Act 5 — The Demon King** (Experience): a boss with phases, each phase a chapter of experience.
7. **Act 6 — Dawn** (transition): the castle breaks, white light, a blink.
8. **Act 7 — The Mansion** (Contact): morning calm, ink and paper, a crow carries the message.

Target runtime: about 4 minutes if the visitor watches everything, under 60 seconds if they use the quick menu. Every act can be skipped.

What I changed from your draft, and why:

- **The swordsman gets his own breathing style: Ink Breathing.** Your name is written in ink on the door, the contact details are written in ink at the end, so ink becomes the thread tying the beginning to the ending. It also makes the hero your own creation instead of a copy. Swap back to Water Breathing anytime; the shots stay the same.
- **Demons turn to ash, and the ash re-forms into the skill or project card.** This makes every reveal feel earned instead of a card simply popping up.

- **The drum has a meaning.** One taiko hit means "the world is about to shift." The visitor learns this in Act 1, so later drums create anticipation. The final sound of the site is a soft bamboo clack in the garden: the drum, finally at peace.
- **The Demon King's health bar is your experience timeline.** Each phase of the fight is one job, internship or program.
- **A crow carries the visitor's message.** The contact form is the paper on the table; pressing Send folds it and a messenger crow flies it out into the garden.
- **Pillars are named by element** (Water Pillar, Flame Pillar). See the note in Production notes about keeping the visuals original for a public site.

Story bible

These rules stay the same across every act, so the visitor learns the language of the site without being told.

Sound motifs

Sound	Meaning	Where it appears
Single taiko hit	The world is about to shift	Every act transition
Double taiko hit	Danger is close	Before the door, before the Upper Ranks, before the King
Heartbeat (low thump)	Time slowing down	Every slow-motion shot
Sharp inhale	A breathing form is starting	Every attack
Total silence (1 sec)	Impact or revelation	Name reveal, final blow on the King
Wind chime + crickets	Safety	Quiet Room, Mansion
Bamboo fountain clack	Peace; the drum at rest	Final scene only

Color script

The color of light tells the visitor how far through the night they are.

Act	Main palette	Mood
1 The Fall	Deep indigo, cold purple, small orange lanterns	Lost, dizzy
2 Quiet Room	Warm amber, wisteria purple	Safe, personal
3 Battlefield	Dark base + each Pillar's element color	Energy, teamwork
4 Upper Ranks	Crimson and black	Pressure, high stakes
5 The King	Black, blood red, then gold light leaking in	Final struggle, hope
6 Dawn	Pure white to soft gold	Release
7 Mansion	Morning green, pale wood, wisteria	Calm, gratitude

The swordsman and Ink Breathing

The visitor rides along with one swordsman, your avatar. He never speaks except to call his forms. His blade leaves black ink strokes that fade to grey, like a brush on rice paper. Every one of his forms is named after a stroke of calligraphy:

- **First Form: Falling Stroke** — a downward spiral that slows a fall (used to land in Act 2).
- **Second Form: Splitting Line** — one clean horizontal slash (used on the Upper Ranks).
- **Final Form: Signature** — the blade writes a full circle in the air (the final blow on the King).

Camera words used in this script

Term	What it means in simple words
Wide shot	Camera far away, you see the whole place
Close-up	Camera very near, one face or object fills the screen
Extreme close-up (ECU)	Only eyes, a hand, or the blade edge
POV	We see through the swordsman's eyes

Term	What it means in simple words
Dolly in / out	Camera moves closer / farther in a straight line
Tracking shot	Camera moves alongside a moving thing
Crane up / down	Camera rises / drops vertically
Orbit	Camera circles around a subject
Whip pan	Camera spins very fast sideways, image blurs, used to cut to a new place
Dutch angle	Camera tilted sideways, feels uneasy
Speed ramp	Action goes slow, then fast, then slow again
Rack focus	Focus shifts from near object to far object
Low angle	Camera below, looking up; makes the subject powerful

Act 0 — Breath (Loading screen)

The loading screen is the first breath of the story, and the Enter click is the swordsman opening the castle door.

Shot 0.1 — Total Concentration

- **Camera:** Flat black screen, no 3D yet.
- **Action:** A thin ink circle in the center slowly grows and shrinks like breathing. Below it, small text: *Total Concentration... 42%*. The circle fills with ink as loading progresses.
- **Sound:** None. Browsers block sound until the first click, so we use the silence on purpose.

Shot 0.2 — The Door

- **Camera:** Same frame.
- **Action:** When loading finishes, the circle becomes the outline of a paper sliding door. Text fades in: *Headphones on. Breathe in.* The door itself is the Enter button. A small link under it: *Skip the story*.
- **Sound:** On click, a soft wooden slide.

- **Visitor:** Click the door. It slides open, and light from inside floods the screen, which is the first frame of Act 1. No cut.

Act 1 — The Fall (Home page)

The Home page is one continuous fall that ends with the visitor knowing the name, the role, and the rule that a drum means change. Scroll controls the fall; the percentages show how far down the page each shot sits. Runtime is about 35 seconds at normal scroll speed.

Shot 1.1 — The Threshold (auto, 0–3 sec)

- **Camera:** Wide shot from behind the swordsman, slow dolly in.
- **Action:** He stands in a dim wooden corridor, just past the door the visitor opened. Ahead is darkness and one dying lantern. His sleeve moves slightly in a draft from below.
- **Sound:** Crickets from outside, then they stop all at once.

Shot 1.2 — First Drum: The Drop (scroll 0–10%)

- **Camera:** Snap to a top-down shot directly above him. Hold for half a second as he falls away, then the camera dives after him.
- **Action:** On the drum hit, the floorboards under him split and swing down like trapdoors. He drops into deep darkness, getting smaller in frame.
- **Sound:** TAIKO hit. Wind rush that keeps rising.

Shot 1.3 — Endless Corridors (scroll 10–35%)

- **Camera:** The camera swings from above him to his side and becomes a tracking shot falling at his speed. It slowly rolls 180° so the world turns upside down.
- **Action:** Corridors, staircases and rooms rotate past at impossible angles. Hundreds of paper lanterns stream upward past the camera; the ones near the lens are blurred. His coat and hair whip upward.
- **Sound:** Wind, faraway wooden creaks, rooms grinding as they shift.
- **Visitor:** Scroll speed is fall speed. Moving the mouse tilts the camera a few degrees, so near lanterns slide more than far ones (parallax). A brush hint fades in and out: *Scroll to fall*.

Shot 1.4 — Double Drum: Danger (scroll 35–40%)

- **Camera:** Tracking shot holds; it pushes in slightly toward his face.

- **Action:** A wave of darkness travels up the shaft and every lantern goes out. A beat later they relight red. Far below, a single paper door appears, rushing up toward him.
- **Sound:** DUM-DUM. Wind cuts out for one beat, then returns lower and heavier.

Shot 1.5 — Racing the Door (scroll 40–50%)

- **Camera:** The camera leaves the swordsman and swings out to the side, level with the door. It tracks alongside the door as it rockets upward, so the visitor feels its speed. Speed lines streak past.
- **Action:** Behind the first door, more doors snap into place one after another, extending like a telescope. The swordsman is a small figure at the top of the frame, falling toward them.
- **Sound:** Rhythmic wooden clacks as each door locks in place, getting faster.

Shot 1.6 — POV: The Tunnel of Doors (scroll 50–60%)

- **Camera:** Cut to the swordsman's POV, looking straight down.
- **Action:** A tunnel of doors rushes at us. Each one slides open just before we hit it (left, right, left, right), revealing the next one closer. The rhythm speeds up.
- **Sound:** His breathing, loud and close. The door clacks sync to it.

Shot 1.7 — Slow Motion: The Name (scroll 60–70%)

- **Camera:** Still POV. Time drops to 5% speed. Rack focus from the wooden frame to the paper.
- **Action:** The last door does not open. Inches from our face, an invisible brush writes on the paper stroke by stroke: **This is Akhilesh Singh**. Smaller underneath: *your role here, e.g. AI Engineer · Full-Stack Developer*.
- **Sound:** Everything goes silent except a slow heartbeat. Each brush stroke has a faint paper scratch.
- **Visitor:** The page pauses here briefly so the name can be read; scrolling resumes after the last stroke.

Shot 1.8 — The Dodge (scroll 70–80%)

- **Camera:** POV barrel-rolls 180° left. Then cut to a third-person side shot, still in slow motion: the swordsman twists in mid-air and the door passes so close it brushes his hair. Speed ramp back to full speed.
- **Action:** As the door passes, the ink of the name peels off the paper as particles, follows him, and settles at the top-left of the screen. **That is now the site logo for the rest of the journey.**

- **Sound:** A deep whoosh as time snaps back. Wind returns.

Shot 1.9 — Ink Breathing: Falling Stroke (scroll 80–100%)

- **Camera:** Low angle from below as a lit room rushes up toward him. Then an orbit shot that circles him once, following his spiral.
- **Action:** Extreme close-up of his eyes opening. He inhales and draws his blade. Brush title slams in: **Ink Breathing · First Form · Falling Stroke**. Black ink ribbons spiral around him; each loop slows the fall. He lands on one knee on a tatami floor. An ink ripple spreads across the floor, and wherever it touches, a lantern lights up.
- **Sound:** Sharp inhale, blade drawn, a soft whoosh per spiral, a quiet thud on landing.

Transition to Act 2: No cut. The lanterns lighting up one by one *are* the Quiet Room appearing.

Act 2 — The Quiet Room (About page)

After 35 seconds of chaos, the About page is the visitor's first moment of calm, and that contrast is what makes the story feel like the anime. The room is safe because wisteria hangs outside every window, and in this world demons cannot come near wisteria.

Shot 2.1 — The Room Reveals Itself

- **Camera:** Starts low on the kneeling swordsman, then cranes up and back to a wide shot of the whole room.
- **Action:** He rises and slides his sword back into its sheath. The room: tatami floor, paper walls, a low table with a cup of tea still steaming, wisteria swaying behind the windows, incense smoke curling. Four scrolls hang on the far wall.
- **Sound:** The sheath click. Wind chimes. Soft crickets return. A slow, quiet shamisen melody begins.

Shot 2.2 — The Scrolls

- **Camera:** Slow pan along the wall, passing each scroll.
- **Action:** Each scroll has one brush word on its outside. Suggested four: **Who I Am**, **My Path** (education), **What Drives Me**, **Beyond Code** (hobbies, interests).
- **Visitor:** Hovering a scroll makes it sway and its word glow faintly. Clicking it dollies the camera in until the scroll fills the screen; it unrolls downward and the text writes itself in ink. Clicking outside rolls it back up and the camera dollies out.

Shot 2.3 — Your Portrait (optional)

- **Camera:** Slow push-in on a folding screen beside the scrolls.
- **Action:** Your photo, stylized as an ink-wash painting. When the camera gets close, the ink settles from blurry to sharp.

Shot 2.4 — The Warning

- **Camera:** Extreme close-up of the tea cup.
- **Action:** After the last scroll is read (or the visitor keeps scrolling), rings appear on the surface of the tea. Again. Again. The lanterns flicker. The swordsman's hand moves to his sword.
- **Sound:** A heartbeat-like thump from far below, getting louder. The music stops mid-note.

Shot 2.5 — The Floor Opens

- **Camera:** Wide shot from the ceiling looking down.
- **Action:** On the drum hit, the tatami mats flip open one after another like falling dominoes, racing from the far wall toward him. He doesn't run. He closes his eyes, and the floor under him opens. The camera stays at the ceiling for one second looking down into the hole, then dives after him.
- **Sound:** TAIKO hit, mats slapping open in rhythm.

Transition to Act 3: During the short fall (about 3 seconds of black), the visitor *hears* the battle before seeing it: steel clashing, demons screaming, fire roaring, thunder cracking. In film this is called a sound bridge, and it builds anticipation for the reveal.

Act 3 — The Battlefield (Skills page)

Each Pillar is one skill group: they defeat a swarm of weak demons, and the ash re-forms into that group's skill icons. Every Pillar uses the same 7-shot template, so you build the sequence once in code and reuse it with different colors, effects and skills.

Opening shots

Shot 3.1 — Hero Landing

- **Camera:** Low angle, close to the ground.
- **Action:** The swordsman slams down in a three-point landing. A ring of dust and cracked stone blasts outward. The dust slowly clears.
- **Sound:** Heavy impact, then the full battle sound arrives clearly.

Shot 3.2 — The Battle Map

- **Camera:** Crane up and rotate 360° to reveal everything.
- **Action:** A giant chamber of floating wooden platforms at crazy angles, some upside down. On each platform, a Pillar fights a swarm of shadowy demons with glowing red eyes. Each Pillar's element glows in their color, so from far away they look like colored beacons across the dark.
- **Visitor:** The camera settles in a wide view. Two choices: **scroll** to visit each Pillar in order, or **click any glowing beacon** to fly straight to that Pillar. A small "battle map" in the corner shows which Pillars have been visited.

The Pillar template (repeat for each skill group, 6–8 seconds each)

#	Shot	Camera	What happens	Sound
A	Approach	Fast fly-through across the gap to the Pillar's platform	Demons blur past; the camera ducks a claw	Wind rush, demon growls
B	Breath	Extreme close-up of eyes and mouth, slow motion 20%	Glowing breath mist in the element color	Heartbeat, deep inhale
C	The Call	Close-up, slight low angle	The Pillar calls the form's name; a brush title card slams in, in the element color	The voice line, a drum accent
D	Strike	Speed ramp: slow wind-up, real-speed blur, freeze at peak	The element becomes a huge painted shape (a water dragon, a fire tiger) frozen for half a second	Silence, then one huge impact
E	Reverse	Whip around to the demons' side	Demons freeze, crack like dry clay, and turn to ash drifting upward	Crumbling, a sigh of wind
F	Skill reveal	Slow orbit around the floating icons	The ash swirls together and forms the skill icons in an arc, glowing in the element color	A soft chime per icon

#	Shot	Camera	What happens	Sound
G	Exit	Whip pan with motion blur	Carries the camera to the next Pillar	Whoosh

Visitor interaction during the template: at shot B, a breathing ring appears. The visitor **presses and holds** to fill it, and **releases** to make the Pillar strike. If they don't interact for 3 seconds, the strike happens on its own. On shot F, hovering an icon shows a small card: the skill name, how long you've used it, and which project used it.

Pillar to skill mapping

Nine Pillars would make this act too long, so pick the **5–6 strongest skill groups** for full sequences and show the rest fighting in the background. Example skills are placeholders; replace them with your own.

Pillar	Look of the attack	Skill group	Why it fits	Example skills
Serpent	Purple slashes that coil and twist	Core languages	A serpent for Python	Python, JavaScript, C++
Mist	Fog that hides, then reveals	AI and LLMs	AI finds what's hidden in data	LangChain, LangGraph, RAG, Ollama
Water	Flowing blue ribbons	Data and ML	Data flows through pipelines	Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn
Flame	Spiraling orange fire	Frontend	The most visible, passionate work	React, Next.js, Three.js
Sound	Shockwaves in rings	Backend and APIs	Signals travelling between systems	FastAPI, REST, Node.js
Stone	Heavy spiked chain and boulders	Databases	The solid foundation	SQL, MongoDB, FAISS
Wind	Cutting green gusts	Cloud and DevOps	Carries code to the world	Git, Docker, Vercel
Insect	Tiny precise stings, butterflies	Testing and debugging	Hunts down every bug	Pytest, debugging tools

Pillar	Look of the attack	Skill group	Why it fits	Example skills
Love	Whip-like pink sword trails	UI/UX design	Design made with care	Figma, design systems

Closing shots

Shot 3.3 — Ash Snow

- **Camera:** Wide shot, very slow push in.
- **Action:** The last weak demon dissolves. Silence. Grey ash falls like snow. The Pillars land one by one in a circle around the swordsman.
- **Sound:** Total silence, then only breathing.

Shot 3.4 — The Circle

- **Camera:** Low-angle orbit around the whole group.
- **Action:** All of them standing together, blades lowered, catching their breath. A full-screen moment of teamwork.

Shot 3.5 — Double Drum: The Ascent

- **Camera:** Tilt up, high above the group.
- **Action:** DUM-DUM. The whole chamber rotates and rearranges. Far above, balconies slide into place, and on them stand six tall figures with glowing marks in their eyes: the Upper Ranks. Cut to a low-angle slow-motion shot as the swordsman and all Pillars leap upward together, their element trails rising like a line of fireworks.
- **Sound:** DUM-DUM, grinding architecture, the music returns, faster and darker.

Act 4 — The Upper Ranks (Projects page)

Each Upper Rank demon *is* the problem one of your projects solved, and the visitor delivers the final blow themselves to reveal the project. The Pillar who fights beside the swordsman is the one whose skill group powered that project, which links Act 3 to Act 4.

The Upper Rank template (repeat per project, 10–12 seconds each)

Shot 4.A — The Reveal

- **Camera:** Low angle from the bottom of the balcony stairs, slow dolly in. Then cut to an extreme close-up of the demon's eye as its rank mark glows.

- **Action:** The demon stands still while the swordsman lands in front of it. Brush title card: **Upper Rank Three · The Endless Inbox** (the demon's name = the problem).
- **Sound:** Double drum. A low, unsettling hum unique to each demon.

Shot 4.B — The Demon's Power

- **Camera:** Wide shot, Dutch angle (tilted) to feel uneasy.
- **Action:** The demon unleashes a power that *looks like* the problem. For an inbox problem, thousands of letters swarm like bats. For a tangled data problem, red threads wrap the whole arena.
- **Sound:** The demon's power has its own sound: paper fluttering, threads snapping tight, gears grinding.

Shot 4.C — The Clash (3 quick cuts)

- **Camera:** Fast handheld-style shake, cuts every second.
- **Action:** Cut 1: blades spark against the demon's power. Cut 2: the swordsman dodges, the attack misses by inches. Cut 3: the helping Pillar's element (say Mist, for an AI project) tears an opening in the demon's defense.
- **Sound:** Steel, impacts, the Pillar's voice calling a form.

Shot 4.D — The Final Blow (visitor's turn)

- **Camera:** Freeze on a wide shot. Time stops.
- **Action:** On-screen hint: *Slash.* The visitor **swipes across the screen**. The swordsman performs **Ink Breathing · Second Form · Splitting Line** along the exact line the visitor drew. In slow motion, an ink line appears, and the whole screen splits in two along it, then slides back together.
- **Sound:** Silence, then one clean blade ring.

Shot 4.E — Ash to Project Card

- **Camera:** Slow orbit, then push in until the card fills most of the screen.
- **Action:** The demon crumbles to ash. The ash swirls and forms a tall paper talisman hanging in the air, written in ink:
  - Project name and one-line pitch
  - The problem (the demon), how you solved it, and the result
  - Tech stack, using the same glowing icons from Act 3
  - A small framed window playing a short screen recording of the project on hover
  - Buttons: **Live Demo**, **GitHub**, **Case Study**

- **Visitor:** Close the card to continue, or open the links.

Shot 4.F — To the Next Balcony

- **Camera:** Tracking shot as the swordsman runs up the walls (the castle's gravity shifts for him) to the next balcony.

Demon ideas for typical projects

Name each demon after the problem, not the project. These are starting ideas to adapt to your real projects.

Demon name	Its power (the problem)	Fits a project like
The Endless Inbox	Swarms of letters that never stop	Email triage or automation tool
The Tangled Web	Red threads binding everything together	Knowledge graph or RAG assistant
The Wrong Measure	Scales and numbers that keep shifting	Precision calculator, medical or finance app
The Slow Machine	Gears that stretch time, everything lags	Local AI agent, performance tool
The Faceless Crowd	Hundreds of identical masks	HR, people or customer system
The Market Storm	A whirlwind of candlestick charts	Trading or financial analytics project

Order: Start with your weakest project at Upper Rank Six and finish with your best at Upper Rank One, so the fights get bigger as the projects get more impressive.

Shortcut for recruiters: a "rank board" button (a vertical scroll of six names) lets visitors jump straight to any project card.

Act 5 — The Demon King (Experience page)

The Demon King fight is your experience timeline: his health bar is the timeline, each phase of the fight is one job, internship or program, and he grows stronger each phase just as the work got harder. The act ends at sunrise, the only thing he cannot survive.

Shot 5.1 — The Throne Room

- **Camera:** Extreme wide shot, very slow dolly in for 4 seconds. The King is a tiny figure at the center.
- **Action:** The last Upper Rank falls, and every platform around the group drops away into darkness. Only one huge circular floor remains. At its center, a pale, elegant figure sits calmly, not even looking at them. His calm is what makes him frightening.
- **Sound:** All music stops. Only a ticking sound, like a slow clock.

Shot 5.2 — His Eyes

- **Camera:** Cut to an extreme close-up of his eyes as they open: red, with thin slit pupils.
- **Action:** He speaks one line in a quiet voice, shown as subtitle: *"You have come a long way. Show me what you have learned."*
- **Sound:** A deep bass drop.

Shot 5.3 — The Health Bar

- **Camera:** Same shot; the interface fades in on top.
- **Action:** Across the top of the screen, a long horizontal scroll unrolls. It is divided into ink segments, each labeled with an experience entry and its dates, oldest on the left. **This is the experience timeline.**

The phase template (repeat per experience entry)

#	Shot	Camera	What happens
A	Phase title	Freeze frame, brush title card	Role, organization, dates (for example: *GenAI Lab Trainee · 2026*)
B	Transformation	Low angle, slow motion	The King's body changes shape: new arms, whips, armor, getting more dangerous each phase
C	Battle	Fast Dutch angles, camera shake, wide-to-close cuts	The swordsman and all Pillars attack together; teamwork shots with crossing element trails

#	Shot	Camera	What happens
D	Segment breaks	Push in on the health bar	That segment of the scroll cracks; its ink drips down and writes 2–3 achievements on screen (what you built, numbers, results)
E	Regeneration	Wide shot	The King recovers and changes form for the next phase

Visitor: Scrolling moves through the phases. Clicking any segment on the health bar jumps to that phase.

Shot 5.4 — Hold Until Dawn

- **Camera:** Wide, shaking. Thin gold lines appear in the frame.
- **Action:** In the last phase, the castle walls crack and thin lines of golden light cut through. The King panics for the first time and tries to flee. On-screen hint: *Hold until dawn.*
- **Sound:** The music builds to its loudest point. A rooster, very far away.

Shot 5.5 — Final Form: Signature (visitor's turn)

- **Camera:** Slow motion close-up, then an orbit shot around the swordsman as he moves.
- **Visitor: Press and hold for 3 seconds.** The breathing ring fills.
- **Action:** Brush title: **Ink Breathing · Final Form · Signature**. The swordsman's blade draws one perfect circle in the air, the same circle as the loading screen. The circle fills with light, and the sunrise bursts through it.
- **Sound:** Total silence for one second. Then a single, pure note.

Shot 5.6 — The King Dissolves

- **Camera:** Medium shot, slow motion.
- **Action:** The King is caught in sunlight and dissolves into ash and wisteria petals that blow away. No gore; this is a professional site.

Shot 5.7 — The Castle Falls Apart

- **Camera:** Top-down shot looking down at the swordsman, then a slow pull up and away.

- **Action:** The entire castle comes apart: beams, doors and hundreds of lanterns float upward into the light. The swordsman falls backward with his arms open, peaceful, and closes his eyes. The screen fills with white.
- **Sound:** Everything fades to a soft hum.

Act 6 — Dawn (transition)

Dawn is a 6-second breath between the battle and the ending, told entirely through the swordsman's eyes opening.

Shot 6.1 — White

- **Camera:** Pure white screen.
- **Action:** Nothing for 2 seconds.
- **Sound:** Silence, then one heartbeat.

Shot 6.2 — The Blink

- **Camera:** POV. Black bars (eyelids) close from the top and bottom, then open on a blurry warm image. They close again, then open, and the image slowly comes into focus (rack focus from blur to sharp).
- **Sound:** Birdsong fades in. A light breeze.

Act 7 — The Mansion (Contact page)

The journey ends in the calm of morning, where the visitor finds your contact details written in ink and can leave their own message, carried away by a crow.

Shot 7.1 — Waking

- **Camera:** POV lying on a futon, looking up at dark wooden ceiling beams. The camera rises slowly as he sits up.
- **Action:** Morning light through paper screens. A folded haori sits beside the futon.
- **Sound:** Birdsong, wind in leaves.

Shot 7.2 — The Garden

- **Camera:** Slow pan from the room out through the open screens to a wide view of the garden.

- **Action:** A koi pond, wisteria hanging from a trellis, morning mist. In the distance, the Pillars rest in the garden: one sharpening a blade, one asleep against a tree, one feeding a bird. A bamboo fountain fills with water, tips, and clacks against a stone.
- **Sound:** The bamboo **clack**. This is the drum from the whole story, finally at peace.

Shot 7.3 — The Table

- **Camera:** POV, kneeling at a low wooden table. The camera tilts down to the table.
- **Action:** On the table: a sheet of rice paper, an ink stone, and a brush pen. The brush lifts by itself and writes, stroke by stroke:
  - Email
  - LinkedIn
  - GitHub
  - Download Resume
- Each line becomes a clickable link once written.
- **Sound:** Soft brush strokes on paper.

Shot 7.4 — The Visitor's Turn

- **Camera:** Same POV, slight push in.
- **Action:** A second, blank sheet slides next to the first with faint guide lines: *Your name*, *Your email*, *Your message*. As the visitor types, their words appear in a brush-style font, as if they are writing in ink.

Shot 7.5 — The Crow

- **Camera:** Medium shot of the table, then crane up, following the crow into the sky.
- **Action:** The visitor presses **Send**. The paper folds itself into a small letter. A messenger crow lands on the edge of the table with a caw, takes the letter in its beak, and flies out over the garden. The camera follows it up above the mansion roof, revealing mountains and the full morning sun.
- **Sound:** Wings flapping, a single caw, music swells softly.

Shot 7.6 — The End Card

- **Camera:** Wide sky shot, holding still.
- **Action:** Written across the sky in brush: **Hope you enjoyed the ride.** Below it, two small options: **Fall again** (restarts from Act 1) and **Download Resume**. Optional: movie-style end credits scroll by slowly, listing the tech stack the site was built with.
- **Sound:** Final bamboo clack. Silence.

Production notes

Every cinematic trick in this script maps to a known web technique, and every scene is built as real 3D in Blender first, then played in the browser. The full technical plan lives in the *Midnight to Dawn — Technical Design Document*.

Real 3D, Blender first

All characters (swordsman, Pillars, demons, the King, the crow) are modeled, rigged and animated as real 3D assets in Blender with Claude Code, with toon shading and ink outlines for the anime look. Each act's complete scene, including every camera shot in this script, is built and approved as a preview render in Blender before its web page is created, so the browser plays exactly what was approved.

How each shot becomes code

Cinematic effect	How to build it
Scroll-controlled fall	GSAP ScrollTrigger with `scrub`, mapping scroll progress to the camera's position along a curve path
Planned camera paths	Theatre.js (visual timeline editor) or a `CatmullRomCurve3` path in Three.js
Slow motion and speed ramps	One global time-scale value that every animation multiplies by, e.g. `gsap.globalTimeline.timeScale(0.05)`
POV shots	A second camera attached to the swordsman's head; switch the active camera for the cut
Whip pans	A very fast camera rotation (about 0.2 sec) with motion blur from postprocessing
Hundreds of lanterns	`InstancedMesh`, so hundreds of lanterns cost about the same as one
Ink trails and spirals	Ribbon meshes (MeshLine) plus particles, with a noise shader to make edges bleed like ink
Demons turning to ash	A dissolve shader using a noise texture, plus ash particles spawned from the edges

Cinematic effect	How to build it
Ash forming icons and cards	Particles that animate from random positions to points sampled on the icon shape
Name written stroke by stroke	`A stroke-order texture on the 3D door paper, revealed by a shader uniform`
Screen splitting on the swipe	Record the swipe line, then a postprocessing pass that offsets the two halves of the screen
Press-and-hold breathing	Timer between `pointerdown` and `pointerup` driving the ring's fill
Glow on elements	Bloom from `@react-three/postprocessing`
Sound	Howler.js, with sounds started only after the Enter click

Safety nets for real visitors

- **Name and role visible within 3 seconds.** Show them small on the loading screen; recruiters may never reach the door.
- **Skip button in every act** and a **quick menu** (a small scroll icon) that flies the camera straight to any section.
- **Recruiter mode:** a plain, fast, one-page version of the same content, linked from the loading screen.
- **Mute button** always visible, since sound starts loud.
- **Reduced motion:** visitors whose system asks for less motion get simple crossfades instead of camera flights.
- **Mobile lite version:** fewer particles, lower resolution, shorter sequences. Test on a real phone early.
- **Load in pieces:** keep the first load small and load each act's assets while the visitor is in the previous act.

Keeping it original

Since this will be public and seen by employers, design your own swordsman, Pillars, demons and castle in the anime's spirit rather than copying the show's characters, crests, music or voice clips. Naming Pillars by element (as this script does) and using royalty-free

Japanese instrument sounds keeps it a clear homage while showing that the art and code are your own work.

Build order

1. **Act 1 with grey boxes:** camera fall, door, name reveal, landing. No art yet; prove the scroll and slow-motion system works.
2. **Act 2:** the room and scroll interaction. Now the site has a Home and About.
3. **Act 7:** the contact table and crow. The site is now usable end to end.
4. **Act 4:** project cards and the swipe slash, since projects matter most to recruiters.
5. **Act 3:** build the Pillar template once, then reuse it for each skill group.
6. **Act 5 and Act 6:** the boss phases, sunrise and dawn blink.
7. **Polish:** art, sound design, mobile version, performance.